

A large, gnarled tree with many branches and leaves is in the foreground, partially obscuring the view. In the background, a deep canyon with steep, rocky walls and green vegetation is visible under a cloudy sky.

AUSTRALIA • MEDICAL BOARD AND RANZCR

Registration for radiologists

*The specialist pathway, the expedited route
and Medicare, and the checklist that goes
with it.*

Ethicare Resourcing

Guide and checklist • October 2026

ethicareresourcing.com

What's inside

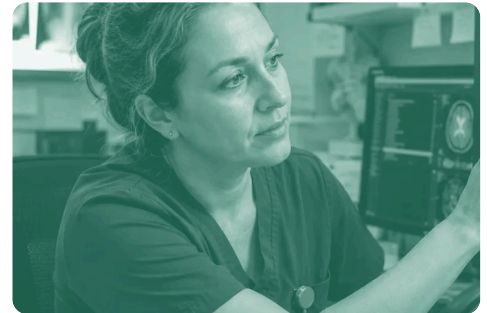
01 Registering as a radiologist in Australia

This guide is free, and so is everything in it. Every chapter here is also on the website, where it is kept up to date — so if you are reading this some months after downloading it, check the site for anything that looks time-sensitive. Fees, tax rates and immigration settings change without much notice.

We don't print these. A PDF costs nothing to send and nothing to ship, which felt like the right answer for a company that spends its days moving people around the world.

Registering as a radiologist in Australia

For consultant radiologists who trained outside Australia and New Zealand. The college assesses you, the Medical Board registers you, and Medicare decides where you can bill. They are three separate steps, and knowing which route is yours before you start saves months. The checklist is built into the page, so nothing you tick goes out of date.



Regulator

Medical Board of Australia, through Ahpra. The Royal Australian and New Zealand College of Radiologists (RANZCR) assesses internationally trained radiologists and advises the Board.

Source

The Board's published requirements at [medicalboard.gov.au](https://www.medicalboard.gov.au) and the College's at [ranzcr.com](https://www.ranzcr.com). Where this page and either of them differ, they are right.

Status

Checked 7 October 2026 against the Board's specialist pathway pages, its Expedited Specialist pathway accepted qualification list (reviewed 30 June 2026), RANZCR's international medical graduate pages, Ahpra's English language standard and the Department of Health's section 19AB pages.

Fees & timings

Deliberately not printed. The Board, the College and the verification services all set and revise their own. Check each current schedule before you budget.

AT A GLANCE

The College advises, the Board decides

RANZCR assesses how comparable your training is to an Australian radiologist's. The Medical Board makes the registration decision on that advice.

Most people take the specialist pathway

A RANZCR comparability assessment, then a period of supervised practice in Australia, then full specialist registration.

Trained in Canada? Check the fast track

Since 1 July 2026 the Canadian Royal College specialist certificate in diagnostic radiology is on the Board's Expedited Specialist pathway. It is the only radiology qualification on that list at present.

Registration is not the same as Medicare

Section 19AB decides where an overseas trained doctor can bill Medicare for ten years. Check the role's location before you accept it.

What's inside

If you remember one thing, make it Section 01: which route is yours. Everything else follows from it. The checklist at the end remembers what you have ticked, on this device.

[Which route is yours](#)

[The RANZCR assessment](#)

[The three outcomes](#)

[The Expedited Specialist pathway](#)

[Your registration along the way](#)

[English language](#)

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SECTION 01 • THE ONE THAT MATTERS MOST

Which route is yours

There are three ways in for a radiologist who trained overseas. Which one applies depends on where you trained and what you already hold, not on the job you are offered.

Most people

The specialist pathway

RANZCR assesses your training and experience and finds you substantially comparable, partially comparable or not comparable. You then practise under supervision in Australia before the Board grants full specialist registration. This is the route for radiologists trained in the UK, Ireland, South Africa and most other countries.

Canadian-trained

The Expedited Specialist pathway

If you hold the Royal College of Physicians and Surgeons of Canada specialist certificate in diagnostic radiology, for training that began on or after 1 July 2002, you can apply to the Board directly, without a college comparability assessment. [Section 04](#) explains how it works.

Already a Fellow

You hold FRANZCR

RANZCR is a joint college for Australia and New Zealand. If you are already a Fellow, you hold the Australian specialist qualification and apply to the Board for specialist registration in the usual way.

Recruited for a regional shortage role?

If an employer offers you a post the College accepts as an area of need, RANZCR can assess you for that position and for comparability at the same time. That assessment includes an interview, clinical case scenarios and film reading. It is a way into a specific role, not a different end point: the aim is still full specialist registration.

SECTION 02

The RANZCR assessment

The College's job is to judge how your training and experience compare with those of a radiologist trained in Australia. It does this from your paperwork first, then in an interview.

1

Verify your qualifications at source

Your primary medical degree and your specialist qualification are verified directly with the institutions that awarded them. This is done through the Educational Commission for Foreign Medical Graduates (ECFMG), using its MyIntealth service. Start early: it depends on universities and colleges replying.

2

Open an Australian Medical Council portfolio

The AMC portfolio holds your verified documents and links your application across the Board and the College.

3

Apply to RANZCR

You send the College its specialist recognition application form with your supporting documents. Once the application is complete, the College invoices you for the assessment.

4

The interview

Two Fellows of the College, both trained assessors, interview you online. It is a structured conversation about your training, your experience and the work you do now.

5

The outcome

The College decides how comparable you are and tells the Board. That finding decides what you need to do in Australia before full specialist registration.

Verify qualifications → AMC portfolio → RANZCR application → Interview → Outcome → Supervised practice → Specialist registration

SECTION 03

The three outcomes

Your outcome is what shapes the first year or two in Australia. The College sets the requirements; these are the outlines it publishes.

Substantially comparable

The most direct route

Up to 12 months of peer review in a RANZCR-accredited training site, practising as a consultant with oversight. When the College confirms you have met its requirements, you apply for full specialist registration.

Partially comparable

Upskilling, then exams

Up to 24 months of upskilling before you sit the College's Part or Phase 2 examinations. It is a longer road, and worth planning around: the role you take needs to support it.

Not comparable

Another route

The College refers you back to the Medical Board, which can tell you about other options for medical registration. The specialist pathway is not the route on the evidence provided.

Before you resign or sell anything.

Wait for your outcome. A partially comparable finding changes your timeline, your role and sometimes your pay, and it is much easier to plan around before you have committed to a date.

SECTION 04

The Expedited Specialist pathway

The Medical Board opened this pathway in October 2024 for specialists whose qualifications it has already judged substantially equivalent to Australia's. Diagnostic radiology joined it on 1 July 2026.

The qualification on the list for radiology is the **Royal College of Physicians and Surgeons of Canada specialist certificate in diagnostic radiology**, for an accredited Canadian residency that began on or after 1 July 2002. At present it is the only radiology qualification on the list. If you trained in the UK, Ireland or elsewhere, the RANZCR specialist pathway in Sections 02 and 03 is your route.

On the expedited pathway you apply to the Board directly, without a college comparability assessment. You are then supervised for six months by an Australian-registered specialist, complete an orientation to the Australian health system and do the Board's mandatory cultural safety education. Because the supervision happens in a job, you need a role lined up.

Everything else is the same as for any other doctor: the English language, criminal history and recency of practice standards all apply.

The list grows.

The Board adds specialties and qualifications as the Australian Medical Council assesses them. If yours is not on the list today, check again before you apply.

SECTION 05

Your registration along the way

On the specialist pathway you do not start on full specialist registration. You hold an interim registration while you complete what the College asks of you.

1

Secure a suitable position

If you are substantially or partially comparable, you need a role, and the Board approves both the position and the supervision arrangements for it.

2

Provisional or limited registration

The Board grants provisional or limited registration for your period of supervised practice. The Board describes this as lasting between three and 24 months, depending on what the College requires.

3

Full specialist registration

When the College confirms you have met its requirements, you apply to the Board for specialist registration in diagnostic radiology.

SECTION 06

English language

Every doctor registering in Australia has to meet Ahpra's English language skills standard, and the expedited pathway is no exception.

There are two broad ways to meet it. If you completed your education in English in one of the countries Ahpra recognises, you may not need to sit a test; that list was widened in 2025, so check it even if you were told otherwise before. South Africa was removed from it at the same time, so if you trained there, check the transition arrangements before you assume you are exempt. Otherwise you sit one of the accepted tests and reach the scores the standard sets.

We do not print the scores here because Ahpra revises them. Read the current standard before you book a test, and time the test so your result is still valid when you apply.

— SECTION 07

Your supporting documents

A clean, complete pack is the biggest thing within your control on timing. Certified copies, clear high-resolution scans, consistent names and every page included.

Passport and proof of identity

Certified, with evidence of any change of name.

Primary medical degree

Verified at source through the ECFMG, with your transcript.

Specialist qualification

Your radiology fellowship or certificate and, where your country issues one, your certificate of completion of training. Also verified at source.

Training record

Your specialist training programme, rotations and assessments, in enough detail for the College to compare it.

Experience since training

A structured CV showing your consultant posts, modalities, subspecialty work and reporting volumes, with no unexplained gaps.

Registration history

Every medical regulator you have been registered with, and a current certificate of good standing from each.

English language evidence

If the standard requires it.

Translations

Certified, supplied together with the original document.

Two things the Board checks itself.

Ahpra checks your criminal history, including in the countries you have lived in, and tells you how to provide what it needs. You also need professional indemnity insurance in place before you practise; your employer will tell you what their cover includes.

— SECTION 08

Medicare, and where you can work

Registration lets you practise. Whether you can bill Medicare, and where, is a separate question decided by section 19AB of the Health Insurance Act.

Section 19AB applies to every doctor who qualified overseas. For ten years from your first medical registration in Australia, you can generally only access Medicare benefits in areas classed as having a shortage. For specialists other than GPs, those areas are called Districts of Workforce Shortage, and each specialty has its own map. Diagnostic radiology is assessed separately from other specialties, so a town that is a shortage area for one specialty may not be for radiology. The ten years can be shortened by working in more remote areas, and work in a public hospital that does not bill Medicare is not restricted.

This matters most in private practice, where your reports are billed to Medicare. Before you accept a role, ask the employer to confirm the location's status for diagnostic radiology, or search the Health Workforce Locator by specialty yourself. Once you are registered, you apply to Services Australia for a Medicare provider number.

One more licence to know about: each state and territory regulates the use of radiation separately, and doctors who operate radiation equipment, for example in fluoroscopy or interventional work, generally need a licence under the local rules. Your employer will usually tell you what applies where you are going.

— SECTION 09

The visa

Most radiologists we support move on an employer-sponsored visa, the 482. Your employer sponsors the role; the Board registers you. Both have to happen, and they run side by side.

The Department of Home Affairs sets the visa rules and publishes them in full. Visa agents can be expensive and are not always necessary; many people apply themselves with their employer's help. If your situation is complicated, a registered migration agent can advise you, and Home Affairs explains how to check that an agent is registered.

— BEFORE YOU APPLY

Five things, in this order

Work out which route is yours. Start verifying your qualifications, because it takes the longest. Check the English standard. Find a role whose location and supervision fit your route, and check its Medicare status for radiology. Then apply to the College, or to the Board on the expedited pathway.

— WHERE PEOPLE GET STUCK

Almost every avoidable delay traces back to one of these

Starting verification late

Primary source verification depends on universities and colleges replying. It is usually the slowest part, so start it first.

Assuming the expedited pathway applies

For radiology it currently covers the Canadian certificate only. UK and Irish qualifications go through RANZCR.

A CV the College cannot compare

Missing modalities, subspecialty work or reporting volumes, so the assessors cannot see the full picture of your practice.

Accepting a role before checking Medicare

A role in a location that is not a shortage area for radiology can limit what you can bill.

Committing before the outcome

Resigning or setting a moving date before you know whether you are substantially or partially comparable.

The wrong English test, or too early

Check the current standard before booking, and time the test so the result is still valid.

The fix for all of these

Know your route, start verification early, describe your practice fully, and check the role's location and supervision before you say yes.

SECTION 11

The questions we are asked most

I trained in the UK. Can I use the expedited pathway?+

Who decides whether I am comparable?+

Can I work while I complete supervised practice?+

What does partially comparable mean for me?+

Does section 19AB stop me working in a city?+

Do I need a visa agent?+

SECTION 12

The whole journey on one page

From first decision to first report. Each stage links to the section that explains it; the checklist tracks the same stages.

Before you start

Work out your route

Specialist pathway, expedited pathway, or already a Fellow. [Section 01](#)

Preparing

Verify your qualifications

ECFMG verification and your AMC portfolio. Start these first. [Section 02](#)

Preparing

English, if the standard requires it

Read the current standard, then time any test. [Section 06](#)

Applying

Apply to RANZCR, or to the Board

The College for the specialist pathway; the Board for the expedited pathway. [Section 02](#), [Section 04](#)

Assessment

Interview and outcome

Substantially, partially or not comparable. [Section 03](#)

Lining up

The role, supervision and Medicare

A position the Board approves, in a location that works for Medicare. [Section 05](#), [Section 08](#)

Moving

Registration granted, visa approved

Provisional or limited registration, and the 482. [Section 09](#)

In Australia

Supervised practice, then specialist registration

Peer review or upskilling, then full specialist registration.

THE CHECKLIST

Twenty-four items, in the order you will meet them

Tick as you go. Ticks are saved on this device only – nothing is sent to us – and the list is always the current version, which a downloaded copy never is.

0 of 24 ticked

[Clear all ticks](#)

01 Work out your route

Everything else depends on this.

- ☐ **Check whether you hold FRANZCR** If you do, you already hold the Australian specialist qualification.
- ☐ **Check the Board's Expedited Specialist pathway list** For radiology it currently lists the Canadian Royal College certificate only.
- ☐ **Otherwise, plan for the RANZCR specialist pathway** Comparability assessment, supervised practice, then specialist registration.
- ☐ **Ask whether the role is an area of need post** If so, the College can assess you for the role and for comparability together.

02 Verify your qualifications

Usually the slowest step. Start it first.

- ☐ **Open a MyIntealth account** For primary source verification through the ECFMG.
- ☐ **Request verification of your primary medical degree**
- ☐ **Request verification of your specialist qualification**
- ☐ **Open your Australian Medical Council portfolio**

03 Gather your documents

Certified, complete and consistently named.

- ☐ **Passport and proof of any name change**
- ☐ **Training record and certificate of completion of training**
- ☐ **A structured CV with modalities, subspecialties and volumes**
- ☐ **Certificates of good standing from every regulator** Current at the time you submit.
- ☐ **Certified translations of anything not in English**

04 English

Read the standard before you book anything.

- ☐ **Check whether your education meets the standard without a test**
- ☐ **If not, book an accepted test, timed to stay valid**

05 Apply and be assessed

The College, or the Board on the expedited pathway.

- ☐ **Submit your application and pay the invoice**
- ☐ **Prepare for the RANZCR interview** Two Fellows, online, about your training and practice.
- ☐ **Read your outcome and what it asks of you** Before you resign or set a moving date.

06 Line up the role

Registration, supervision and Medicare need to fit together.

- ☐ **Confirm the position and supervision the Board will need to approve**
- ☐ **Check the location's section 19AB status for diagnostic radiology**

☐ Ask which state radiation licence you need

07 Registration and the move

The last steps before your first report.

☐ **Apply for registration with Ahpra** Provisional or limited on the specialist pathway.

☐ **Visa application with your employer**

☐ **Apply for a Medicare provider number once registered**

WHAT NEXT?

Registration is one part of the decision

Consultant radiologist in Australia What the work is like, public and private practice, and where the roles are. **How registration works in Australia** For every profession: Ahpra, the boards, the sequence, English and timelines. **Medical imaging in Australia** The family of professions, and the pages for each. **Visas for Australia** The 482 and the other routes, in plain English. **Plan your move** Registration, visas, family and the order to do it in, personalised and saved in your browser. **Create my pack** Tick the guides you want and we will email them to you in one place.

HOW WE HELP

We line up the role and the registration so they move together

Where we have a radiology vacancy that fits, we help you secure the role and the supervision your route needs, and we guide the timing of your applications so one does not hold up the other. The registration decision always rests with the Medical Board of Australia, on the College's advice.

[See current vacancies](#)

[The Board's own site ↗](#)